Associate practice questions — set 1

10 free questions for the Claude Certified Associate – Foundations exam (CCAO-F). The correct option and its reasoning appear under each question — read them through, or cover the answer block and treat it as a timed self-check.

Question 1 **Output Evaluation and Validation**

Claude drafts a supplier comparison and states that Vendor K has ISO 27001 certification, although the supplied proposals do not mention it. What should the associate do before using the comparison?

A. Treat the certification claim as unverified and check it against an authoritative supplier source.

B. Keep it because the statement is plausible.

C. Replace ISO 27001 with a different certification.

D. Improve the table formatting and leave the claim unchanged.

Correct answer: A

Plausible wording is not evidence; the unsupported claim must be verified or removed.

Question 2 **Workflow Integration and Solution Design**

A team spends every Monday copying survey comments into categories before analysts review them. What is the best first step when considering Claude for this workflow?

A. Automate the entire process immediately.

B. Map the current inputs, decisions, exceptions, outputs, and review points before redesigning it.

C. Choose the largest model before defining the use case.

D. Remove analyst review to maximize speed.

Correct answer: B

Workflow analysis should establish requirements and control points before tool selection or automation.

Question 3 **Prompting and Task Execution**

A manager asks, 'Write something useful about our launch.' Which revision is most likely to produce a usable first draft?

A. Repeat the same request in capital letters.

B. Ask for maximum creativity without constraints.

C. Specify the audience, purpose, required facts, tone, length, and desired format.

D. Request ten unrelated versions before defining the goal.

Correct answer: C

A concrete task, audience, context, and constraints make success observable.

Question 4 **Governance, Risk, and Responsible Use** **Select all that apply**

An HR team wants Claude to rank job applicants and automatically reject the lowest-scoring candidates. Which two safeguards are most important?

A. Test the process for unfair criteria or disparate effects.

B. Hide the use of AI from applicants.

C. Treat a confident ranking as objective evidence.

D. Require qualified human review before any employment decision.

Correct answer: A, D

Human review preserves accountability for a consequential decision. Explanation for A: Bias testing addresses ethical and fairness risks in the ranking process.

Question 5 **Product and Model Selection**

A consultant is building an interactive cost calculator that colleagues should adjust in the conversation. Which Claude feature is the closest fit?

A. An artifact that presents the calculator as a usable standalone output.

B. A new Project used only as a blank chat.

C. Research mode for every calculation.

D. A persistent memory entry containing the final number.

Correct answer: A

Artifacts are appropriate when the output itself should be viewed or interacted with separately.

Question 6 **Troubleshooting and Optimization**

A recurring summary includes the required risk only when it appears near the beginning of the source. What experiment best tests the likely weakness?

A. Change the model, format, and source at the same time.

B. Move equivalent risk evidence to several source positions while holding the prompt and evaluation criteria constant.

C. Add unrelated examples until the output becomes longer.

D. Test only documents where the risk appears first.

Correct answer: B

A controlled position test reveals whether context placement, rather than the requirement itself, drives the omission.

Question 7 **Configuration and Knowledge Management**

A Project contains a policy handbook that has just been superseded. What should its owner do?

A. Leave both versions unlabeled so Claude can choose.

B. Add a prompt telling Claude to ignore all dates.

C. Replace or update the source and review instructions that refer to the old policy.

D. Create a new chat while retaining stale knowledge.

Correct answer: C

Project knowledge and dependent instructions must be maintained when authoritative material changes.

Question 8 **Output Evaluation and Validation**

Two Claude drafts are factually correct, but one is written for engineers and the other for executives. How should the associate select between them?

A. Choose the longer draft automatically.

B. Choose whichever was generated first.

C. Combine every sentence from both drafts.

D. Evaluate which draft matches the intended audience, decision need, and level of detail.

Correct answer: D

Output quality includes fitness for the intended audience, not factual accuracy alone.

Question 9 | Prompting and Task Execution | Select all that apply

A request covers market research, pricing, launch planning, and an executive memo. Which two actions best decompose the work?

A. Define a separate deliverable and success criterion for each stage.

B. Ask for all outputs in one undifferentiated paragraph.

C. Draft the conclusion before gathering relevant evidence.

D. Order stages so verified research informs pricing and the final memo.

Correct answer: A, D

Separate deliverables make each stage reviewable. Explanation for D: Logical sequencing ensures later work uses validated earlier results.

Question 10 | Workflow Integration and Solution Design

A sales director asks whether Claude will eliminate the need for account managers. What is the most accurate way to communicate its value?

A. Promise that it will replace the role after deployment.

B. Explain the tasks it can augment, the expected benefits, and the decisions that remain with people.

C. Describe only model capabilities and omit workflow limits.

D. Avoid discussing uncertainty until after launch.

Correct answer: B

Stakeholders need task-level value, limitations, and human ownership rather than an absolute replacement claim. END OF FLASH DRILL

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